ENHANCING THE GLORY OF VENERABLE TEMPLES

Development works like Shri Mandir Parikrama Prakalpa, Samalei Project, Bakulban and Nrusinghanath-Harishankar are dramatically improving the devotee experience at these revered sites.

In the heart of spirituality and devotion lies an endeavour that transcends mere architecture and transcends into an immersive journey of the soul. The Shri Mandira Parikrama and Samalei Project stand as a testament to the harmonious blend of tradition and innovation, creating an unparalleled experience for pilgrims and visitors alike.

Shree Jagannath is the 'Aradhya Devata' of Odias and millions of Hindus across India and the world. He is worshipped as Brahmadaru at his Mula Peetha at Puri. The Shri Mandira Parikrama is a 75-metre corridor around the Shree Jagannatha Mandir at Puri. The project provides expansive, unobstructed corridors around the Meghanada Pacheri, giving devotees and pilgrims an opportunity to have a visual connect with the Temple, Neelachakra and Meghanada Pacheri. The Parikrama also serves the function of providing amenities for pilgrims and for strengthening safety and security of the temple and devotees. The Rs 800-crore project was unveiled by the Chief Minister in the presence of Gajapati Maharaja of Puri Divyasingha Deb and representatives of about 90 temples on 17 January 2024. It is the core part of the ongoing plan to develop Puri into a world heritage city, to cater to the growing number of footfalls of devotees and visitors.

Likewise, the SAMALEI (Samaleswari Temple Area Management and Local Economic Initiative) Plan was comprehensively developed to provide a unique experiential experience to visitors and pilgrims by creating an ambience of spirituality. The project includes peripheral development of the shrine, construction of a heritage corridor, amenities for pilgrims, improved access to the temple, and development of the Mahanadi riverfront. The major objectives of the SAMALEI Plan are to celebrate the grandeur of the Maa Samaleswari Temple; enhance devotees' experiences; boost the tourism-based economy of Sambalpur and Odisha; and develop other projects around the temple to facilitate economic opportunities for locals. All buildings and heritage gates have been designed in Kalingan architecture and khondalite stones have been used for paving and cladding.

An integrated tourism development plan at the Nrusinghanath and Harishankar temples is meanwhile transforming the Gandhamardan region. With the creation of a centre of living, interpretation centre, kiosks, washrooms, and temple premises beautification, the project aims to enhance the improving pilgrim and visitor experience at these two important shrines.

The integrated tourism development project at Sakhigopal Temple in Puri district has envisaged kiosks, washrooms, temple premises beautification of Chandan Pond, temple front plaza beautification, information kiosk, heritage gateway, and beautification of Shyam Kund. The mesmerising garden is called Bakulban.



